connections within one HTTP/2 connection, which makes each connection more efficient. With HTTP/1, there is no multiplexing, which is similar to how walkie-talkies work: while one is talking, the other can only listen, and vice versa. HTTP/2, on the other hand, is like WhatsApp, where you can chat with someone while both can write and read independently.

gPRC allows different communication patterns:

- *Unary RPC*—A single request from the client generates a single response from the server.
- *Server streaming*—The server issues multiple responses to a single request from the client.
- *Client streaming*—Multiple messages sent by the client generate a single request from the server.
- *Bidirectional*—The client and server can send multiple requests and responses during the lifetime of the connection. The way requests and responses are handled is application-specific. In a logical sense, there are two different streams, one from the client and one from the server, which are managed separately at the application level.

You can find more on this at https://grpc.io/docs/what-is-grpc/core-concepts.

11.2.3 The plugin and the .proto file

Akka gRPC is a plugin you can add to the project/plugins.sbt file:

```
addSbtPlugin( "com.lightbend.akka.grpc" % "sbt-akka-grpc" % "2.1.6")
```